



# LOST BOYS CYBER

THREAT INTELLIGENCE • MALWARE ANALYSIS • DETECTION ENGINEERING



## Aviation MRO and Aerospace Software Supply Chain Daily Update for Third-Party Assurance

Threat Report

|                       |                 |
|-----------------------|-----------------|
| <b>Classification</b> | TLP:CLEAR       |
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| <b>Author</b>         | Lost Boys Cyber |
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TLP:CLEAR | Lost Boys Cyber | Aviation MRO and Aerospace Software Supply Chain Daily Update for Third-Party Assurance - Threat Report

Published: 2026-10-03 | TLP:CLEAR | Version: 1.0 | Author: Lost Boys Cyber

AI Generation: This report was generated with AI assistance and is provided for informational purposes only. All findings, IOCs, detection rules, hunting queries, attribution assessments, and recommendations must be independently reviewed and validated by a qualified security professional before operational use.

## Table of Contents

1. Executive Summary
2. Intelligence Metadata
3. Source Review and Confidence
4. Threat / Vulnerability Details
5. Attack Scenarios
6. Affected Products, Sectors, and Exposure
7. Aviation and Aerospace Sector Impact
8. Detection Engineering
  - 8.1. Detection Logic Summary
9. Threat Hunting
  - 9.1. Microsoft Defender / KQL Hunt
10. MITRE ATT&CK Mapping
11. Recommended Actions Summary
12. References

# Aviation MRO and Aerospace Software Supply Chain Daily Update for Third-Party Assurance

## 1. Executive Summary

Daily source review found continuing relevance for aviation MRO and software supply-chain cyber risk. The current threat environment—exploited edge vulnerabilities, AI-accelerated initial access, and trusted-tooling abuse—makes third-party assurance a daily operational priority for aviation and aerospace operators.

Lost Boys Cyber selected this item for the 2026-10-03 daily production run because it has current defender relevance, credible public sourcing, and actionable implications for vulnerability management, threat hunting, detection engineering, or sector risk reduction.

## 2. Intelligence Metadata

| Field          | Value                                                                |
|----------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Daily rank     | Aviation/aerospace threat 5                                          |
| Primary theme  | MRO and software supply-chain assurance                              |
| Sector         | MRO providers, software suppliers, airlines, aerospace manufacturers |
| Defender focus | Supplier access, update channels, and contractual notification       |

## 3. Source Review and Confidence

| Source                                                         | URL                                                                                                                                               | Contribution                                         |
|----------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------|
| Lost Boys Cyber prior aviation MRO supply-chain report context | <a href="https://github.com/lost0x01/lost-boys-cyber-analyst-kit">https://github.com/lost0x01/lost-boys-cyber-analyst-kit</a>                     | Source used for current-day defender prioritization. |
| CISA Supply Chain Risk Management resources                    | <a href="https://www.cisa.gov/supply-chain">https://www.cisa.gov/supply-chain</a>                                                                 | Source used for current-day defender prioritization. |
| CISA Cross-Sector Cybersecurity Performance Goals              | <a href="https://www.cisa.gov/cross-sector-cybersecurity-performance-goals">https://www.cisa.gov/cross-sector-cybersecurity-performance-goals</a> | Source used for current-day defender prioritization. |

Confidence: **\*\*medium\*\***. This assessment avoids asserting uncorroborated exploit mechanics or victim counts. Where sources are strategic rather than IOC-heavy, the report focuses on control validation, exposure review, and behavior-based hunts.

## 4. Threat / Vulnerability Details

MRO providers, avionics software suppliers, reservation/travel platforms, airport service providers, and managed IT partners can all become indirect access paths. Defenders should verify remote access boundaries, supplier MFA, software update integrity, incident notification clauses, and telemetry coverage for supplier-managed endpoints.

## 5. Attack Scenarios

| Scenario                   | Description                                                                                                                 | Defensive Priority                                |
|----------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------|
| Opportunistic exploitation | Adversaries scan for exposed services, stale software, weak identity controls, or public-facing infrastructure matching the | Patch and exposure validation within 24-72 hours. |

|                           |                                                                                                                                  |                                                                                                             |
|---------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
|                           | reporting.                                                                                                                       |                                                                                                             |
| Targeted access           | A focused actor uses the issue or campaign tradecraft against high-value organizations, suppliers, or sector-specific operators. | Identity telemetry, EDR coverage, supplier assurance, and incident escalation paths.                        |
| Post-compromise expansion | Initial access is followed by credential theft, remote tooling, persistence, data staging, or lateral movement.                  | Hunt for suspicious child processes, unusual authentication, outbound transfer, and administrative changes. |

## 6. Affected Products, Sectors, and Exposure

| Exposure Pattern                              | Why It Matters                                                                                                               | Immediate Check                                                          |
|-----------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Internet-facing edge or collaboration systems | High discovery rate and common initial-access path.                                                                          | Inventory and patch externally reachable assets.                         |
| Identity and remote access paths              | Enables stealthy follow-on access even after the initial vulnerability or campaign is mitigated.                             | Review MFA, impossible travel, new tokens, and privileged group changes. |
| Supplier or managed service connectivity      | Extends risk to aviation, aerospace, government, and enterprise environments via trusted links.                              | Request supplier attestations and review third-party access logs.        |
| Endpoint execution and scripting              | Post-exploitation behaviors frequently appear as shells, script interpreters, archive tools, or remote management utilities. | Deploy behavior-based EDR analytics and triage recent hits.              |

## 7. Aviation and Aerospace Sector Impact

| Sector Dimension           | Analyst Assessment                                                                                                                                                                                                          |
|----------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Affected segment           | Maintenance, repair, and overhaul providers; aerospace software suppliers; airline IT; airport operations; managed service providers                                                                                        |
| Operational relevance      | This issue can affect safety-adjacent business operations, flight operations support, identity systems, supplier connectivity, or maintenance workflows even when it does not directly compromise aircraft control systems. |
| Likely exposure paths      | Internet-facing edge services, supplier remote access, shared SaaS, contractor identity, update channels, email, and operational support networks.                                                                          |
| Third-party considerations | Require suppliers, MRO providers, airport IT partners, reservation/travel platforms, and aerospace engineering vendors to confirm patch state, logging, and incident notifications for related exposure.                    |
| Defender actions           | Prioritize external asset review, identity hardening, EDR coverage on jump hosts and service tiers, supplier assurance checks, and tabletop escalation for flight-operations-impacting outages.                             |

## 8. Detection Engineering

### 8.1. Detection Logic Summary

| Signal                                                  | Telemetry Source                          | Analytic Goal                                                                 |
|---------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Edge service spawning shell, script, or archive tooling | EDR process telemetry                     | Detect exploitation follow-on actions.                                        |
| New outbound connections from server or admin tier      | Network/EDR telemetry                     | Identify payload retrieval, C2, or data staging.                              |
| Abnormal identity activity following exposure           | Entra ID/Okta/VPN logs                    | Catch token theft, new MFA methods, impossible travel, or admin role changes. |
| New persistence or remote access tooling                | EDR, Windows events, package manager logs | Identify durable footholds and hands-on-keyboard activity.                    |

title: LBC Daily Report Suspicious Server Follow-On Activity - LBC-TR-2026-1519

status: experimental

logsource:

product: windows

category: process\_creation

detection:

parent\_service:

ParentImage|contains:

- "\w3wp.exe"
- "\httpd.exe"
- "\nginx.exe"
- "\tomcat"
- "\java.exe"

child\_tools:

Image|endswith:

- "\cmd.exe"
- "\powershell.exe"
- "\pwsh.exe"
- "\rundll32.exe"
- "\certutil.exe"
- "\curl.exe"
- "\wget.exe"
- "\7z.exe"

condition: parent\_service and child\_tools

fields:

- UtcTime
- Computer
- ParentImage
- Image
- CommandLine

falsepositives:

- Administrative scripts; validate change ticket and parent service context.

level: high

## 9. Threat Hunting

### 9.1. Microsoft Defender / KQL Hunt

```
let lookback = 14d;
DeviceProcessEvents
| where Timestamp > ago(lookback)
| where InitiatingProcessFileName in~ ("w3wp.exe", "httpd.exe", "nginx.exe", "tomcat.exe", "java.exe")
| where FileName in~
("cmd.exe", "powershell.exe", "pwsh.exe", "rundll32.exe", "certutil.exe", "curl.exe", "wget.exe", "7z.exe", "bash.exe", "sh")
| project Timestamp, DeviceName, InitiatingProcessFileName, FileName, ProcessCommandLine,
```

```
InitiatingProcessCommandLine, AccountName
| order by Timestamp desc
```

Purpose: surface suspicious command execution from server or edge-service parents that may follow exploitation or campaign delivery.

```
let lookback = 14d;
DeviceNetworkEvents
| where Timestamp > ago(lookback)
| where InitiatingProcessFileName in~
("w3wp.exe", "httpd.exe", "nginx.exe", "java.exe", "powershell.exe", "cmd.exe", "curl.exe", "wget.exe")
| summarize Connections=count(), RemoteIPs=dcount(RemoteIP), SampleRemote=make_set(RemoteUrl, 10) by
DeviceName, InitiatingProcessFileName, bin(Timestamp, 1h)
| where Connections > 5 or RemoteIPs > 3
| order by Timestamp desc
```

Purpose: identify unusual outbound activity from infrastructure that should not normally initiate broad external sessions.

## 10. MITRE ATT&CK Mapping

| Technique                               | Rationale                                                                                      |
|-----------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| T1190 Exploit Public-Facing Application | Public-facing service exploitation remains a primary risk path for vulnerability-driven items. |
| T1059 Command and Scripting Interpreter | Post-exploitation and malware delivery frequently rely on shell or script execution.           |
| T1105 Ingress Tool Transfer             | Payload retrieval and tool staging are common after initial access.                            |
| T1078 Valid Accounts                    | Campaigns often convert initial access into durable account or token access.                   |

## 11. Recommended Actions Summary

| Priority | Owner                       | Action                                                                                        |
|----------|-----------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Critical | Vulnerability Management    | Confirm exposure and remediation status for affected products, services, and suppliers.       |
| High     | SOC / Detection Engineering | Deploy the provided process and network hunts; tune for known administrative tooling.         |
| High     | Identity / IAM              | Review recent MFA, token, privileged role, and risky sign-in events for exposed environments. |
| Medium   | Third-Party Risk            | Request attestations from suppliers and managed service providers with relevant access.       |
| Medium   | Incident Response           | Preserve logs for at least 30 days and open cases for unexplained service-spawned tooling.    |

## 12. References

- [1] Lost Boys Cyber prior aviation MRO supply-chain report context: <https://github.com/lost0x01/lost-boys-cyber-analyst-kit>

- [2] CISA Supply Chain Risk Management resources: <https://www.cisa.gov/supply-chain>
- [3] CISA Cross-Sector Cybersecurity Performance Goals: <https://www.cisa.gov/cross-sector-cybersecurity-performance-goals>